



Wizpy

What on earth is Wizpy?

Wizpy is a Linux-based portable media player that supports the OGG, WMA, MP3, AAC, DivX, and JPEG formats. You can also view text files on its 1.71-inch display. What's more, you can connect it to your USB port and boot into Linux.

Who developed it?

It is the brainchild of Turbolinux, a Japanese Linux developer.

What apps come bundled?

Wizpy comes loaded with Turbolinux' Linux OS "Fuji" with the Linux Kernel 2.6.19, which is updatable. Also bundled is Firefox, Thunderbird, Skype, Turbo Media Player, Adobe Reader, CD and DVD ripping software, OpenOffice 2.1, RealPlayer 10, and Justsystem's ATOK Japanese Input System.

How does it work?

Simply hook it up to the computer and boot into your own version of OS. Wizpy has Flash memory with a bootable Linux OS that uses at the most 1 GB of memory from the player. The host computer will detect Wizpy as a USB bootable device and boots into Fuji. Wizpy uses its own output system so users can plug in their own output peripherals for sound. Files and documents are stored either in the media folder or on the documents folder of the host PC. The media folder on the host PC will be accessible only when Wizpy is connected, and the documents folder is accessible only by using Wizpy's OS.

Where can be Wizpy used?

Wizpy is compatible with both PCs and Intel-based Macintoshes.

When will be Wizpy be available?

It debuted in February 2007 in Japan, and the rest of the world will get it after April of this year.



that soldier looks, we're still going to be bursting into peals of laughter when you shoot him in the foot and he goes down holding his face! If it's not that, then it's your own squad stupidly standing around getting shot at, or an enemy using a predefined route to get to your position.

Well, one step at a time we guess, real faces in two years, and real behaviour in 200?

INDIA MORE MOBILE

Mobile Market Growing Rapidly

Normally a common meeting ground to discuss possible strategies for China, the 3GSM World Congress (<http://3gsmworldcongress.com/>) was all abuzz about India. Vodafone's 11 billion dollar acquisition of Hutchison Essar was also part of a lot of conversations.

The reason global mobile service companies have lost a little interest in China and are focussing on India is that China has run its shift to 3G into murky waters. At the same time, India is the fastest-growing mobile segment, and with 150 million subscribers, that's a mere 13 to 15 per cent penetration. Estimates proclaim that

India will soon overtake Russia to become the third-biggest mobile subscriber base, and will reach a whopping 500 million by 2010. Even though financial experts say that Vodafone may have paid a little too much for their acquisition, it's nothing compared to the potential they've bought.

With global players coming into India, the mobile industry is set for a new boom. Pricing will be competitive, services will be ramped up, and the general competitiveness will give us end-users more choices and better service coverage. Since Vodafone plans to start penetrating rural areas immediately, expect a much better connected nation in a couple of years.

Whatever the case, we're going to enjoy ourselves, and hope that 3G finally makes it here to take over from the 2.5G services we have to make do with currently.

EXUDING COOL

Brand New Products From HP

HP recently announced a new range of digital lifestyle consumer products, featuring an industry-first touchscreen PC, a touchscreen notebook, a Desktop PC with a new design, and an iPAQ handheld.

The new TouchSmart PC is a one-of-its-kind. Encased in a shiny piano-black exterior, it exudes class. HP has integrated useful applications such as SmartCalendar, HP PhotoSmart Touch, and other tools to it. The integrated 19-inch touchscreen is bright and uses optical touch recognition, as against the traditional capacitive technologies and HP claims better touchscreen performance.

The new TX-1000 Entertainment Notebook, too, features a touchscreen, and HP claims it is the first notebook optimised to take advantage of Vista's entertainment features. A key feature is its ability to transform into a Tablet PC. It also has HP's entertainment features such as the QuickPlay buttons, a remote control, and a webcam with a microphone.

Then, packed with features is the iPAQ rw6828, the new, chic PDA-phone from the HP stables. Based on a 416 MHz Intel processor, and with 128 MB ROM, a QVA screen, and running Windows Mobile 5.0, this PDA-phone will set a new benchmark for PDA-phones. It comes equipped with Bluetooth, infrared, Wi-Fi (802.11b), tri-band GSM, and GPRS/EDGE. A 2-megapixel camera, inbuilt FM tuner, and a 1 GB mini-SD card enable entertainment.

With IDC forecasting healthy growth for PCs in countries such as India and China, it was but natural for HP to come up with a new range of PCs. The general theme is centred on Black and Slim. HP has banked to a large extent on their industrial design team to come up with new, good-looking, functional designs.

HP India assures that these products will make it to the Indian market by the April / May 2007. ■